A market such as Turkey or Vietnam, weakly correlated with the others, mechanically appears as a receiver. Trading hours add a second source of bias, since all funds trade in New York after the Asian markets have closed. The idiosyncratic network gives a different ranking (Spearman 0.30 with Diebold–Yilmaz): Taiwan and Indonesia are the main transmitters and Argentina is close to neutral. Argentina is thus exposed to the common emerging-market shock rather than to shocks from specific neighbors, and its largest country-specific shock, the August 2019 primary elections, does not turn it into a relevant transmitter in any of the four systems: in our data, that local shock did not spread.

Limitations. First, we study returns, not the realized volatilities of the base paper, so our networks describe the transmission of return shocks, not of risk. Second, ETF prices embed exchange-rate movements against the dollar and US trading hours, which affect the estimated directions. Third, the rolling windows of 104 weekly observations are short for the sparse estimators, whose results depend on tuning choices: NETS is selected by BIC over a grid of 15 values, which makes the series jump from one window to the next, and FNETS requires a positive-definite adjustment of the idiosyncratic covariance, gives an empty network in the full sample, and shows one-window drops that coincide with changes in the number of retained coefficients. With $N = 18$, the cross-section is also small for the factor-number criterion and for the consistency of the dynamic principal components, which rely on large N. Fourth, almost no lagged links survive in the sparse methods, so the Granger networks carry little information. Fifth, consecutive windows share 100 of their 104 weeks, so the stability measures are high partly by construction; they are informative for comparing methods but not as absolute values. Finally, we report no confidence intervals, so small differences, such as 81.0% against 80.0% between Diebold–Yilmaz and the lasso VAR, should not be interpreted as significant.

7 Conclusion

Measured connectedness among emerging equity markets depends less on the estimation method than on whether the common factor is removed. At the weekly frequency connectedness is high, around 80% for the dense measures, and almost entirely contemporaneous; the lasso VAR and Diebold–Yilmaz agree closely, and NETS reproduces the same pattern at a lower level. A single common factor explains more than half of the variance of returns, and removing it lowers connectedness by about 40%, a share that is stable across windows, horizons and samples; the peak of 2020 and the decline afterwards reflect changes in the weight of this factor rather than in bilateral links. Most of the co-movement of emerging markets is therefore common exposure, not contagion. What cannot be claimed with the same confidence is the direction of spillovers between countries, which our data barely identify, and the structure of the idiosyncratic network, which is unstable in short windows. Natural extensions are to study volatility connectedness, as in the base paper, to use higher-frequency data or longer windows for the factor-adjusted estimators, and to add more markets, which would also improve the estimation of the common factor.

Statement on the use of AI tools

The authors used AI tools in the following ways during the preparation of this paper. Claude Deep Research (Anthropic) was used to search for and identify sources and data. Claude Code (Anthropic) was used to write the code that produced the estimations, figures and tables, to typeset the paper in LaTeX, and to draft parts of the text under the authors' direction. The research questions, the structure of the paper, the main modeling decisions, the Discussion and the Conclusion are the work of the authors. The authors reviewed and revised all drafted text, agree with its content, and take full responsibility for the paper.